

imperial

Of or relating to an empire.

imports

Goods bought in from another country.

independence

The liberation of a country, state, or society, which then becomes self-governing.

indigenous

Native to a particular place.

irrigation

The method of supplying land with extra water by means of channels, pipes, or canals.

islet

A small island.

lagoon

An area of shallow water that has been cut off from the sea.

landlocked

An area of land (or water) that is completely surrounded by land.

marine

Of or relating to the sea.

marsupial

A type of mammal whose females carry their young in pouches.

medieval

From or relating to the Middle Ages, a time in history that lasted from 600 to 1500 CE.

minaret

A tall, thin tower that is part of a mosque.

monarchy

A form of government ruled by a king or queen.

oasis

A place in a dry area where there is water, and plants can grow.

**Ottoman Empire**

An empire that was founded in Anatolia (modern-day Turkey) in the 13th century. It controlled much of western Asia, southeastern Europe, and northern Africa from the 14th to 20th centuries.

peninsula

A piece of land that is connected to the mainland but that is almost entirely surrounded by water.

permafrost

Frozen ground found beneath the surface in polar regions.

Polynesia

An area in the central Pacific Ocean that includes many islands, such as Hawaii, Samoa, and New Zealand.

province

A large section of a country that may have its own administration or government.

regatta

A sporting event that involves boat and yacht races.

reggae

A style of music that originated in Jamaica in the 1960s.

relic

An ancient object.

Renaissance

A period of European history from the 14th to 16th centuries, during which an interest in the arts and learning was renewed.

republic

A form of government in which the supreme power lies with the people and their elected representatives.

rift (geology)

A widening crack caused by rocks pulling apart.

Sahel region

A semiarid region in northern Africa located directly south of the Sahara



Desert and which stretches from the Atlantic Ocean to the Red Sea.

sarong

A long piece of cloth wrapped around the body and tucked in at the waist.

savanna

An area of grassland that has few trees.

sea level

The level of the sea's surface in relation to other geographical features such as hills.

souk

An Arab marketplace.

Soviet Union

Officially called the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics, or USSR. It was a collection of 15 federal socialist republics in what is now Russia and parts of eastern Europe and central Asia and which disbanded in 1991.

tapioca

A starch extracted from the cassava plant and which is used as a food thickening agent, especially for puddings.

terraces

A series of flat areas built into a slope-like steps, used for growing crops.

territory

An area of land that belongs to a ruler or state.

textile

A piece of cloth or woven fabric.

tropical

Of or in relation to the area near the Equator.

tundra

The cold, treeless areas around the North and South Pole, where the ground is frozen for most of the year.

volcanic beach

The beach on a volcanic island, where deposits of dark volcanic minerals and rocks are common.

